

The Unofficial Behringer X-Touch Companion

Edition 0.4 – Draft

Chapter 4 – How the X-Touch Thinks

This may be the most important chapter in the guide. Once you understand the controller's mental model, dozens of buttons suddenly become easier to understand.

The Selected Track

DrivenByMoss revolves around the concept of the selected track. Many operations act on the selected track rather than the last fader or encoder you touched. Selecting a track first, then choosing a mode, is the key to predictable behaviour.

Why SELECT Matters

The SELECT button is not simply a highlight. It tells Bitwig and DrivenByMoss, 'this is the track I intend to work on.' Device editing, browser operations and many navigation commands all begin with this decision.

Think in Modes

The X-Touch has a fixed set of physical controls, but their purpose changes with the current mode. A V-Pot might adjust pan in Mixer mode, filter cutoff in Device mode, or scroll through presets in Browser mode. The hardware stays the same; the conversation changes.

Golden Rule

Whenever the controller seems to behave unexpectedly, ask yourself two questions: 1. Which track is selected? 2. Which mode am I currently in? These two answers explain most of the controller's behaviour.

Try It Now

Select Track 1 and enter Device mode. Turn the first V-Pot. Now select Track 2 and repeat. Notice that the same physical control now edits a different device because the selected track has changed.

Looking Ahead

The remaining chapters build on this foundation. Mixer, Browser, Devices and Automation all reuse the same mental model, which is why understanding it early pays dividends later.